

Sean Bocirnea

Updated September 27th 2026 – <https://orcid.org/0009-0007-5231-8618> – <https://passingt.me>

Education

Bachelor of Science, Honours in Computer Science with Software Engineering

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
92.2% GPA

Sept. 2019 – May 2023.

Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
93.0% GPA. Supervised by Professor William J. Bowman

Sept. 2023 – Present.

Research in UBC's Software Practices Lab. Interested in gradual dependent types, performance evaluation, type preserving compilation. Currently performing research in extensible language frameworks and metaprogramming.

Selected Coursework:

Dependent Types (CPSC539B, 2023W, 98%),
Programming Language Principles (CPSC509, 2023W, 94%)

Publications

Sean Bocirnea and William J. Bowman. 2025. Fast and Extensible Hybrid Embeddings with Micros. In *Proceedings of the 26th ACM SIGPLAN International Workshop on Scheme and Functional Programming (Scheme '25)*, October 12–18, 2025, 13 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3759537.3762696>

Adam T. Geller, Sean Bocirnea, Chester J. F. Gould, Paulette Koronkevich, and William J. Bowman. 2025. Type-Preserving Flat Closure Optimization. *Proc. ACM Program. Lang.* 9, OOPSLA1, Article 103 (April 2025), 27 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3720437>

Service

Computer Science Graduate Student Association (CSGSA) Co-President

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

May. 2025 – May 2026

Coordinated and created student activities. Worked with the undergraduate student society alongside my co-president on the CSSRC'26 student research conference (for which I administered the paper submission and review platform). Worked with my colleagues at the CSGSA to manage funding and push forward student initiatives including graduate student social events, information seminars and outreach for student resources.

Department of Computer Science Graduate Affairs Committee Member

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

May. 2026 – May 2027

Negotiation of Graduate student stipend distribution, adjudication of applications for CGRS-M and CGRS-D awards. Discussed matters of supervision, cost of living, and graduation timelines.

Department of Computer Science Student Development Committee Member and CSGSA VP Social

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

May. 2024 – May 2025

Planning and executed social events and professional events, coordinating with the Student Development Committee to meet student needs.

Experience

Software Development Consultant

Motivity Systems, Honolulu, Hawaii

Part-time 2018-Present

Web and server-side development in F# with FRP concepts, product aimed at facilitating ABA therapy. Autonomously performed requirements elicitation, UX/UI design, development and testing of high-priority user-facing features in a fully reactive web application. Development of server-side data structures to support feature additions and interaction with external systems.

Notable Achievements: Interval data collection methodology and interface; result: Motivity application rated best in interval data collection for ABA therapy by the Behavioral Collective. Reactive pagination over arbitrary server queries with live state updates. API surface design for AlohaABA integration. Bulk data collection. Collection of program drafts across users.

Honours Thesis Research

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
Supervised by Professor William J. Bowman

Sept. 2022 – May 2023

Implementation of gradual dependent typed language embedded into Racket. Exploration of interoperability with Racket terms across gradual boundaries. Literature review of topics including the Calculus of Inductive Constructions, Martin-Löf type theory, normalization and decidability of type checking, definitional and propositional equalities.

Teaching

CPSC 311 – Definition of Programming Languages – Graduate Teaching Assistant

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

2023W1, 2026W1

Developed autograder infrastructure, graded assignments, ran tutorial sessions consisting of live-coding problem sets, and held office hours supporting students.

Awards

NSERC CGS-M – UBC, 2024W – \$27,000

BC Graduate Scholarship – UBC, 2024W – \$17,500

Trek Excellence Scholarship – UBC, 2020W, 2021W, 2022W – \$1,500 Each

Charles and Jane Banks Scholarship – UBC, 2020W, 2022W

J Fred Muir Memorial Scholarship in Science – UBC, 2021W

Department of Computer Science Student Community Building Award – UBC, 2024, 2025

Projects

FLEx: Fast Language Extension Framework – UBC, 2024W

Research proficiency evaluation project, successfully passed and transitioned into the Ph.D. program. Developed a taxonomy for categorizing the extensibility of language development frameworks and created a framework which targeted previously unexplored performance and extensibility goals.

Associated Engineering Resume Management System – UBC, 2021W

CPSC 319 Group project (Team of 6) – Task provided by sponsor Associated Engineering. Developed a resume management web application complete with backend API, SQL server and a professional identity provider solution, hosted in Microsoft Azure. UX design lead. Backend and deployment lead. Managed and created continuous integration pipelines, testing and production deployments. Solely responsible for backend framework selection and identity service development, used industry-standard tools.